

Slide 4: Impact and Controversies

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WikiLeaks has had a profound impact on global politics and journalism, while also generating significant controversies:

Exposing Human Rights Violations

WikiLeaks has revealed numerous instances of human rights abuses and civil liberties violations^[1]. The organization's releases have shed light on military operations, diplomatic affairs, and government practices that were previously hidden from public view^[2].

Influence on Global Politics

The release of diplomatic cables in 2010 reshaped geopolitical relationships and exposed sensitive information about international affairs^[2:1]. In 2016, WikiLeaks' publication of Democratic National Committee emails had a significant impact on the U.S. presidential election^[3].

Journalistic Practices and Ethics

WikiLeaks has challenged traditional journalistic norms, forcing media organizations to reconsider their role in handling and publishing classified information^[4]. This has sparked debates about the balance between transparency and national security.

National Security Concerns

Critics argue that WikiLeaks' actions have compromised national security and endangered lives. Some claim that the release of military documents put informants and civilians at risk^[3:1]. The U.S. government has consistently maintained that the leaks posed a threat to national security^[5].

Legal and Diplomatic Repercussions

WikiLeaks' activities have led to criminal investigations and diplomatic tensions. Julian Assange, the organization's founder, has faced legal challenges in multiple countries^[6] ^[7]. The U.S. government has sought to prosecute those involved in leaking classified information^[3:2].

Debate on Transparency vs. Secrecy

WikiLeaks has ignited a global debate on the balance between government transparency and the need for certain levels of secrecy in diplomacy and national security^[1:1]. This has led to discussions about the role of whistleblowers and the public's right to information.



1. <https://www.ifla.org/publications/what-is-the-effect-of-wikileaks-for-freedom-of-information/>

2. <https://policyoptions.irpp.org/magazines/from-climate-change-to-clean-energy/truth-and-consequence-the-wikileaks-saga/>
3. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_material_published_by_WikiLeaks
4. <https://www.cfr.org/interview/how-wikileaks-affects-journalism>
5. <https://www.britannica.com/topic/WikiLeaks>
6. <https://www.npr.org/2019/04/11/712306713/12-years-of-disruption-a-wikileaks-timeline>
7. <https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-68282613>